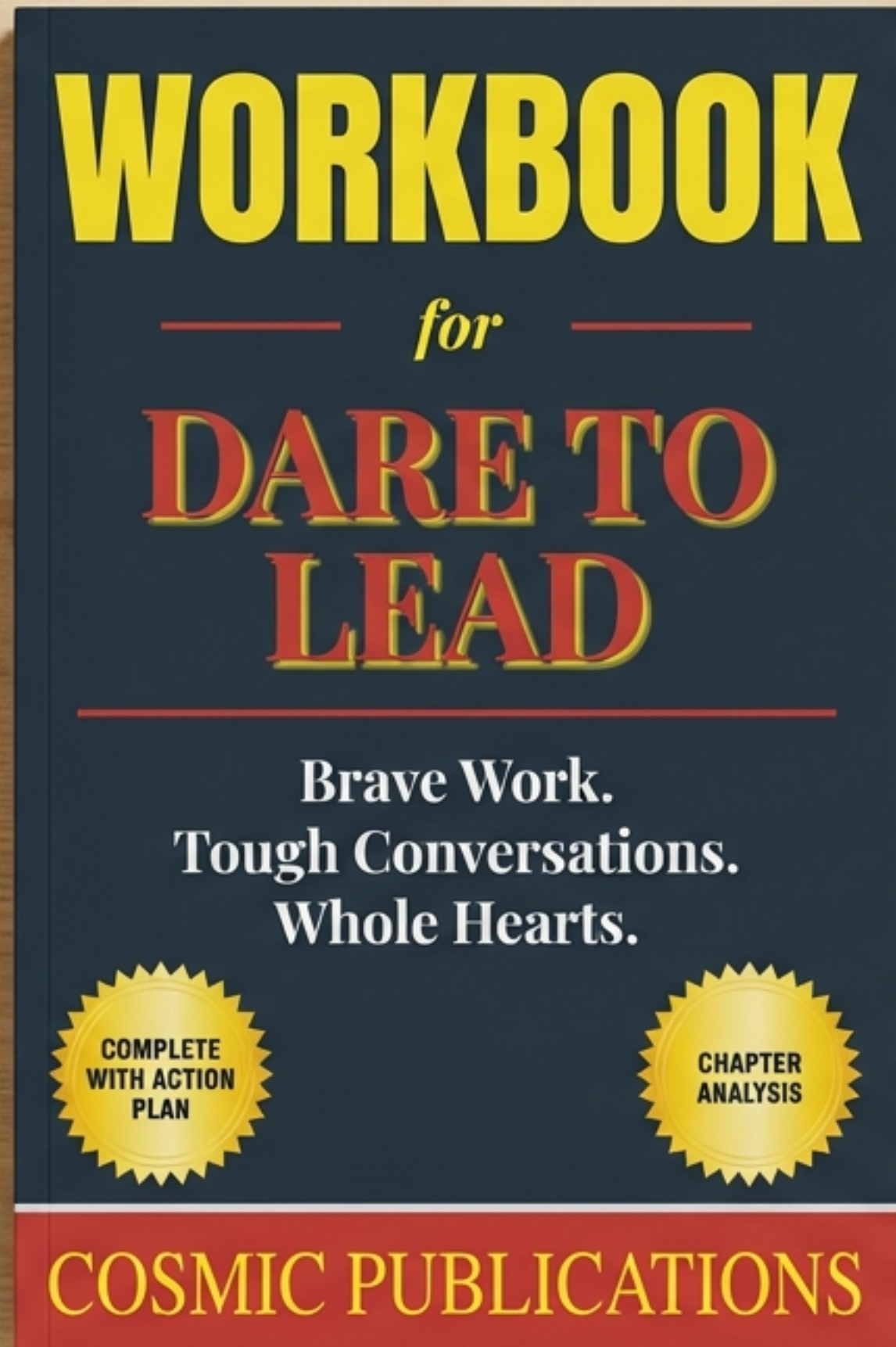




Dare to Lead: An Action Guide

**Brave Work. Tough Conversations.
Whole Hearts.**

This is a deconstruction of Brené Brown's research on leadership, designed to move you from "Armored Leadership" (protecting yourself) to "Daring Leadership" (connecting with others). This deck is a standalone self-coaching tool.

Based on the Workbook Summary by Cosmic Publications.

THE DEFINITION OF DARING

Daring does not mean ‘I’m willing to take a chance on failing.’ Daring means ‘I know I will fail eventually, but I’m still all in.’

Leadership is not about winning or losing. It is the bravery to show up when you cannot control the outcome. Where perfection goes, imperfection follows.

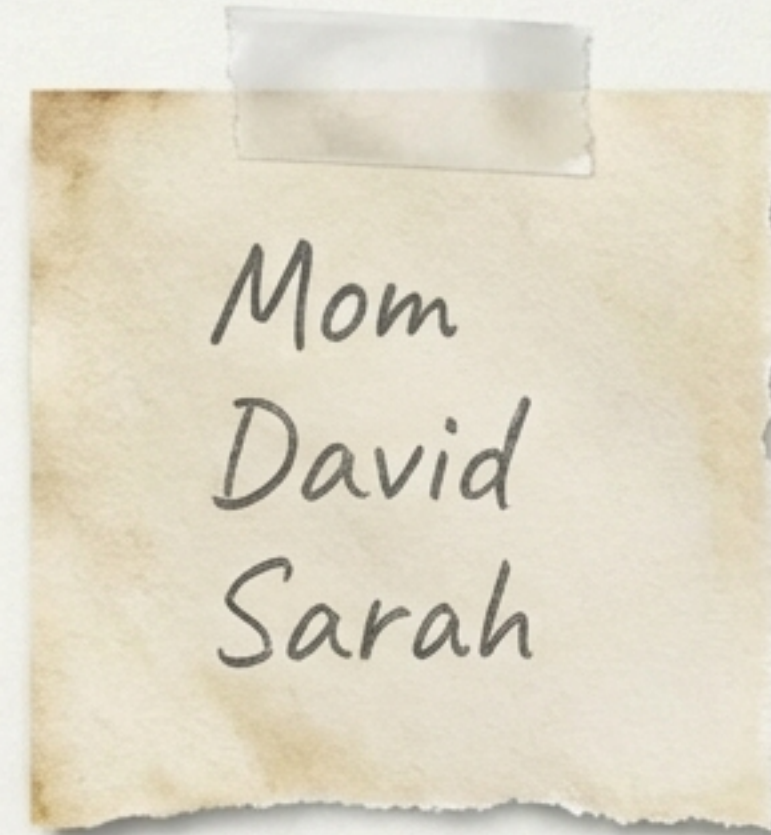
You cannot have innovation without failure.

Exercise: The Square Squad

When you stop caring what anyone thinks, you lose the capacity for connection.

When you care what everyone thinks, you lose the capacity for courage.

The opinions that matter are the people who love you for your vulnerability, not your success.



Action: Take a 1x1 inch piece of paper. Write down the names of the people whose opinions actually matter to you. If you need more space, your list is too long.

The Rumble: Dismantling the Myths

Myth #1

Vulnerability is weakness.

The Reality

Vulnerability is the first thing we look for in others, but the last thing we want to show. It is the accurate measurement of courage.

Myth #2

I don't do vulnerability.

The Reality

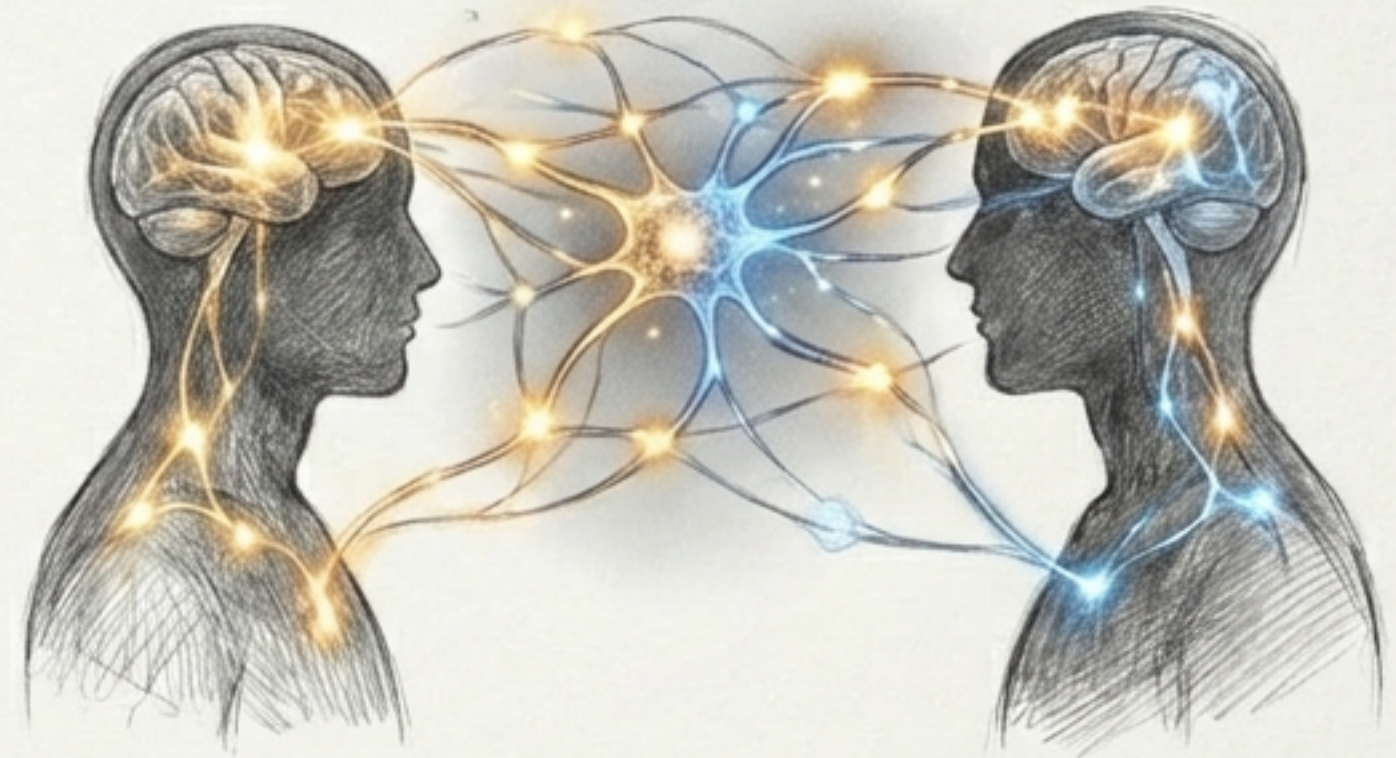
You cannot opt out. Either you do vulnerability, or it does you. Ignoring it means your behaviors will be driven by unconscious fear rather than values.

Myth #3: “I Can Go It Alone”

We often believe that “not needing to be vulnerable” is a strength.

In reality, it is a defense mechanism that leads to isolation.

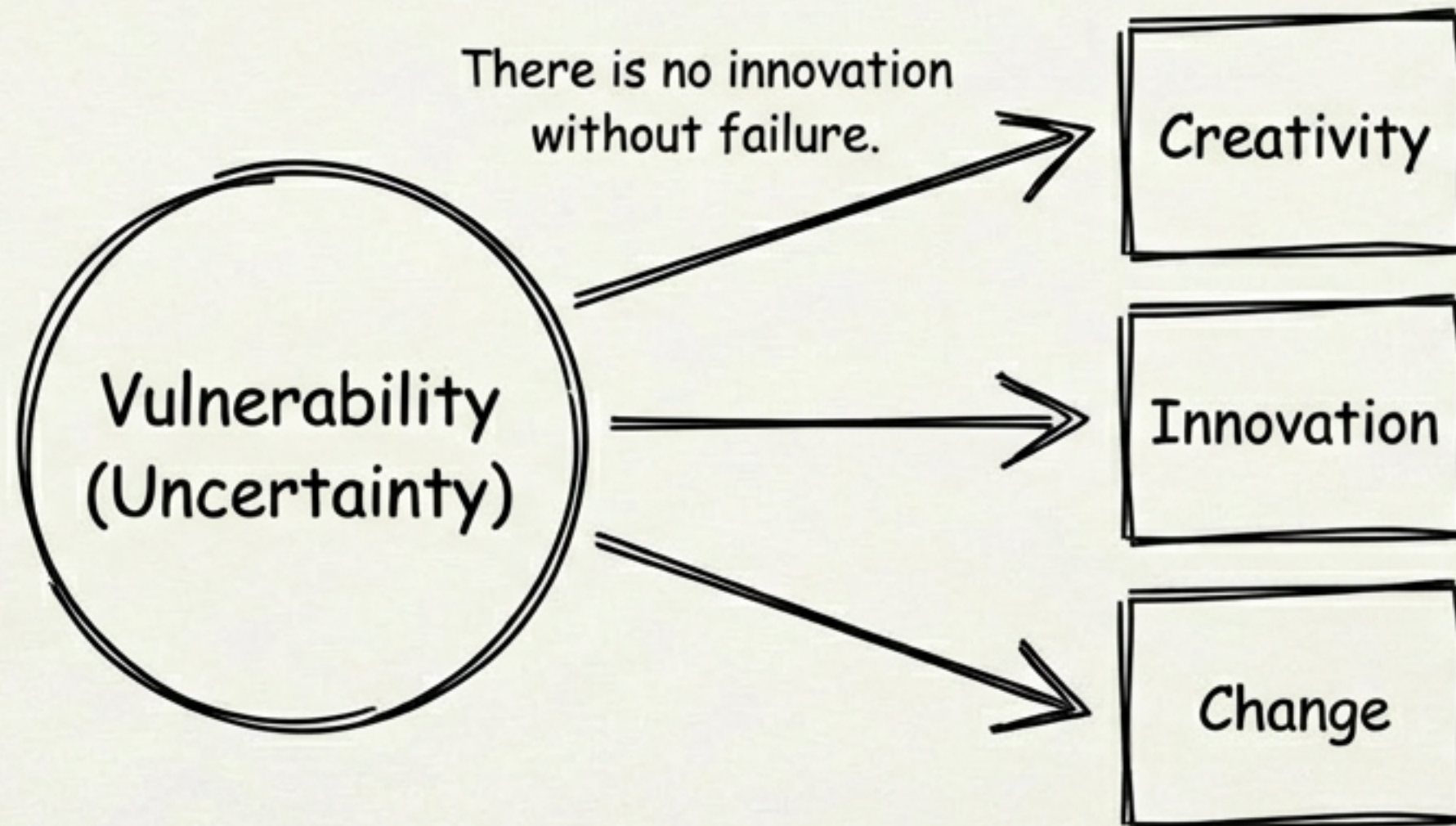
Neurobiologically Wired for Interdependence



Evidence: John Cacioppo's work confirms we are not born autonomous; we are born to depend on others. In the absence of authentic connection, we suffer.

Myth #4: “We Can Engineer the Uncertainty Out”

Many leaders are rewarded for eliminating vulnerability (uncertainty). But if you engineer out vulnerability, you engineer out creativity.



Myth #5: “Trust Comes Before Vulnerability”



The Marble Jar
Concept

- We think we need trust to be vulnerable, but we need vulnerability to build trust.
- Trust is earned in small moments: remembering a name, asking for help, admitting a mistake.
- **Grounded Theory:** You share your secrets only with those who have filled their jar over time.

Myth #6: “Vulnerability is Disclosure”

Vulnerability is not “letting it all hang out” or livestreaming your crisis. It is not using vulnerability for vulnerability’s sake.

The Goal: Psychological Safety

Creating an environment where it is safe to take risks and admit mistakes without fear of retaliation. (Reference: Google’s Project Aristotle found this is the #1 dynamic of successful teams).

PAUSE & REFLECT

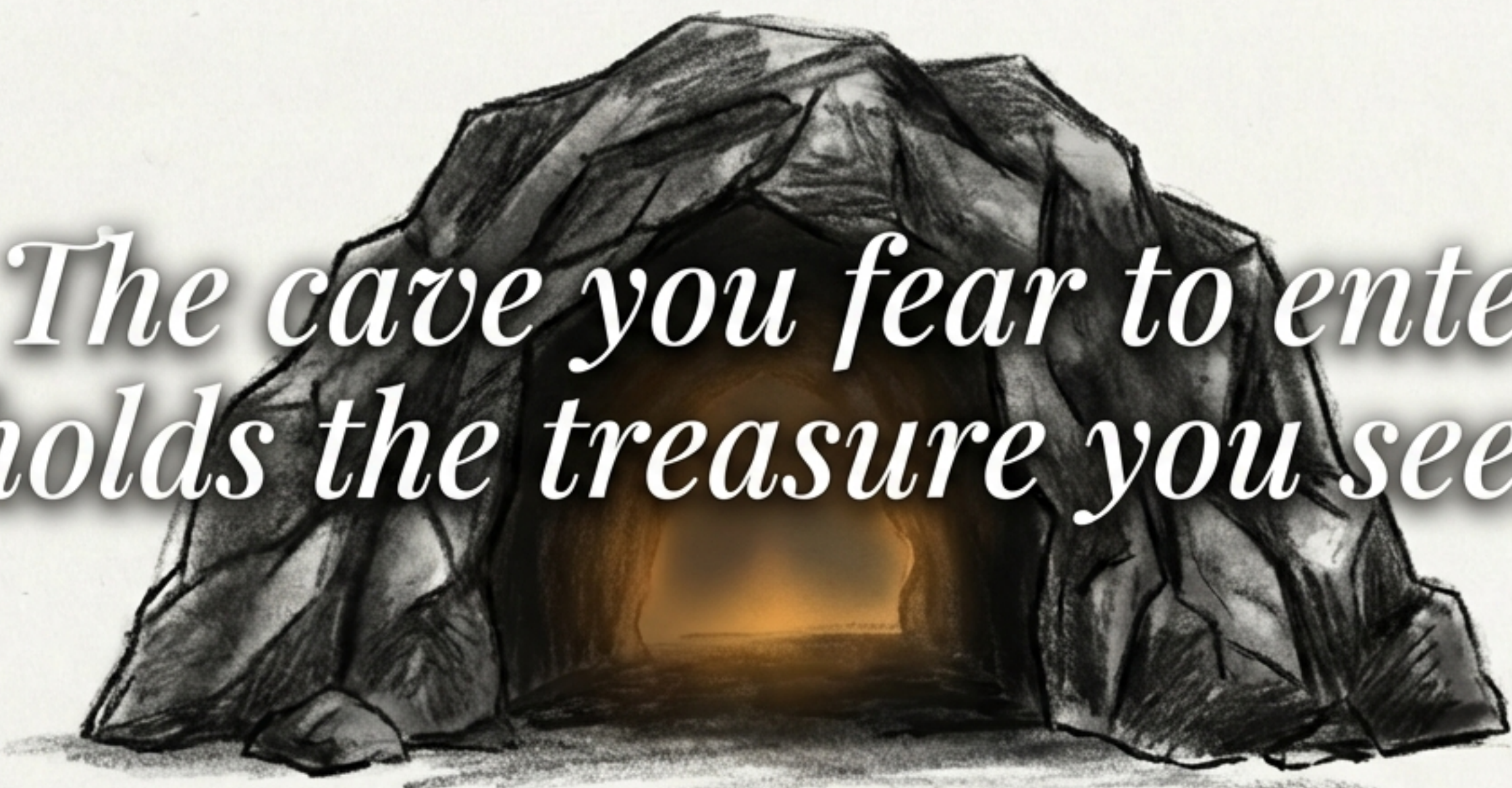
What is the decision you will never make because you know it will cause you pain?

What are the harshest comments you remember? Why do they stick?

Have you ever felt excluded? What was the reason?

Action Step: The next time you feel insecure in a conversation, note it. Revisit the conversation later with a different response.

The Call to Courage

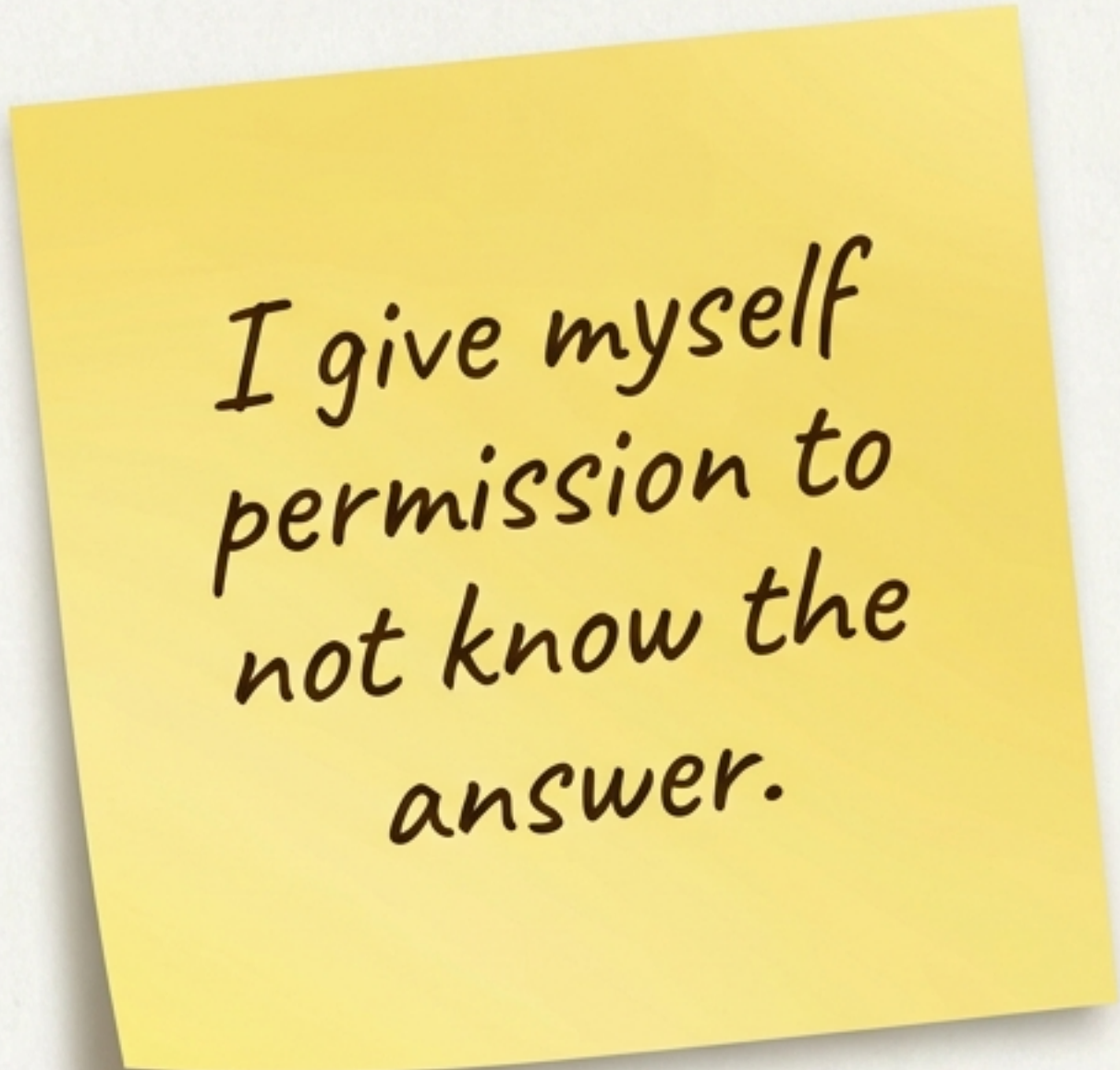


*The cave you fear to enter
holds the treasure you seek.*

— Joseph Campbell

The 'Cave' represents the uncomfortable internal work we avoid—admitting we are stuck, tired, or wrong. Facing this fear is the prerequisite for daring leadership.

Tool: The Permission Slip



*I give myself
permission to
not know the
answer.*

Definition:

A physical or mental note setting an intention for a specific event.

Crucial Distinction:

Permission slips are INTENTIONS, not promissory notes. They are simply to help you own your anxiety.

Examples:

"I give myself permission to be messy."

"I give myself permission to ask for more time."

Case Study: Loneliness vs. Exhaustion

The Story of Colonel DeDe Halfhill

The Situation

Air Force Global Strike Command.

The team seemed lethargic and claimed they were “tired.”

Leaders often try to fix fatigue by sending people home to sleep.

The Pivot

Colonel Halfhill asked, “Are you tired, or are you lonely?”

15 hands went up.

The Lesson: You cannot fix loneliness with sleep. Connection was the cure.



Loneliness vs. Exhaustion: Addressing the Root Cause.

Meeting Tool: Turn & Learn

In meetings, the loudest or most senior voices dominate, anchoring the group's opinion.

1. Everyone writes down their thoughts or estimates on a sticky note BEFORE speaking.



2. Everyone reveals simultaneously.

This prevents 'anchoring' and ensures all voices—not just the loudest—are heard.

Section Three: The Armory

Armor Type 1: Perfectionism

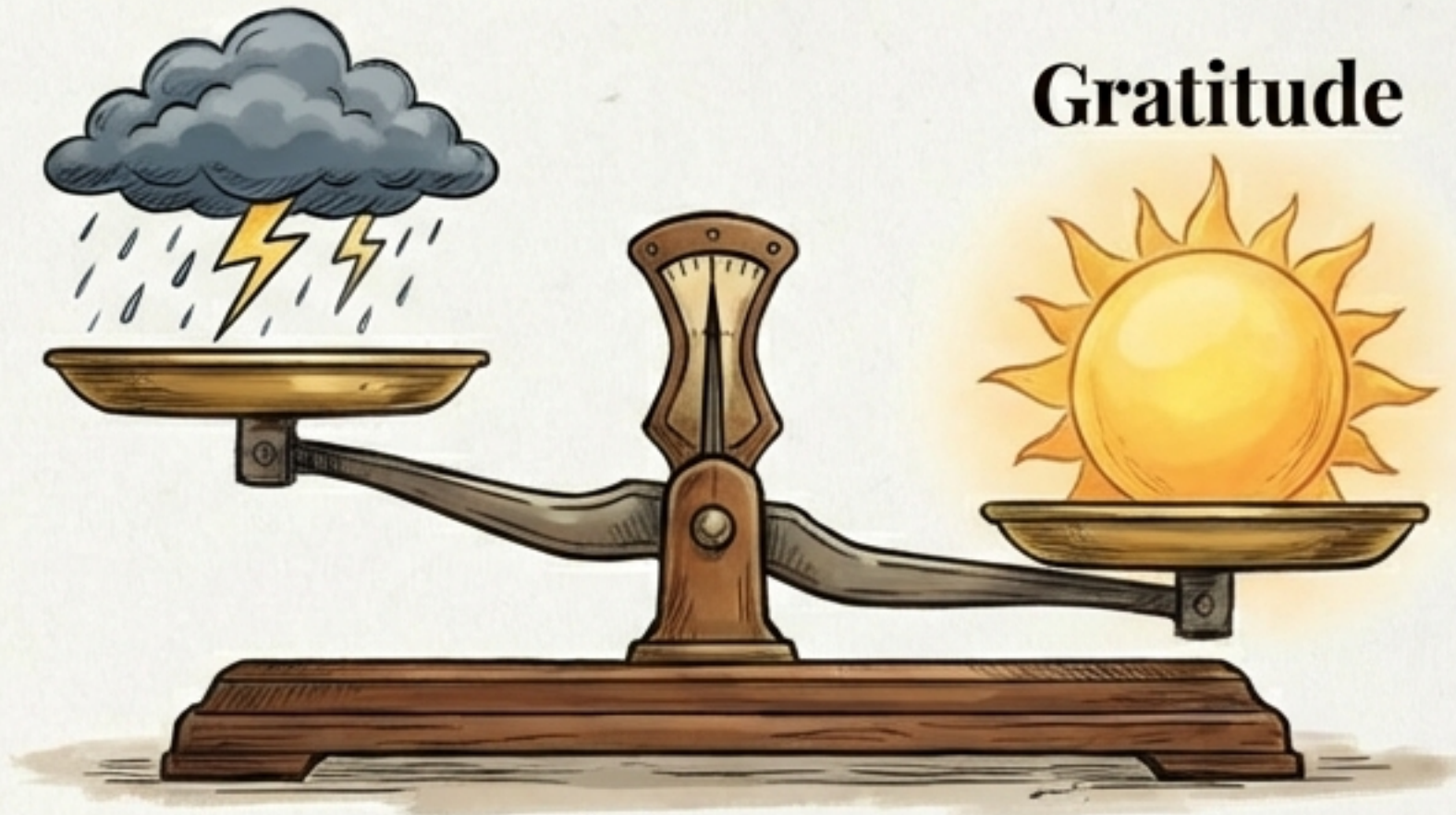


- **The Myth:** Perfectionism is a self-defense mechanism.
- **The Reality:** It is a twenty-ton shield that we lug around. It is self-destructive because perfection does not exist.
- **The Antidote:** Self-Compassion. Moving from “What will people think?” to “I am enough.”

Armor Type 2: Numbing & Foreboding Joy

When things are going too well, we wait for the other shoe to drop.
We numb ourselves to avoid the vulnerability of extreme joy.

Foreboding Joy

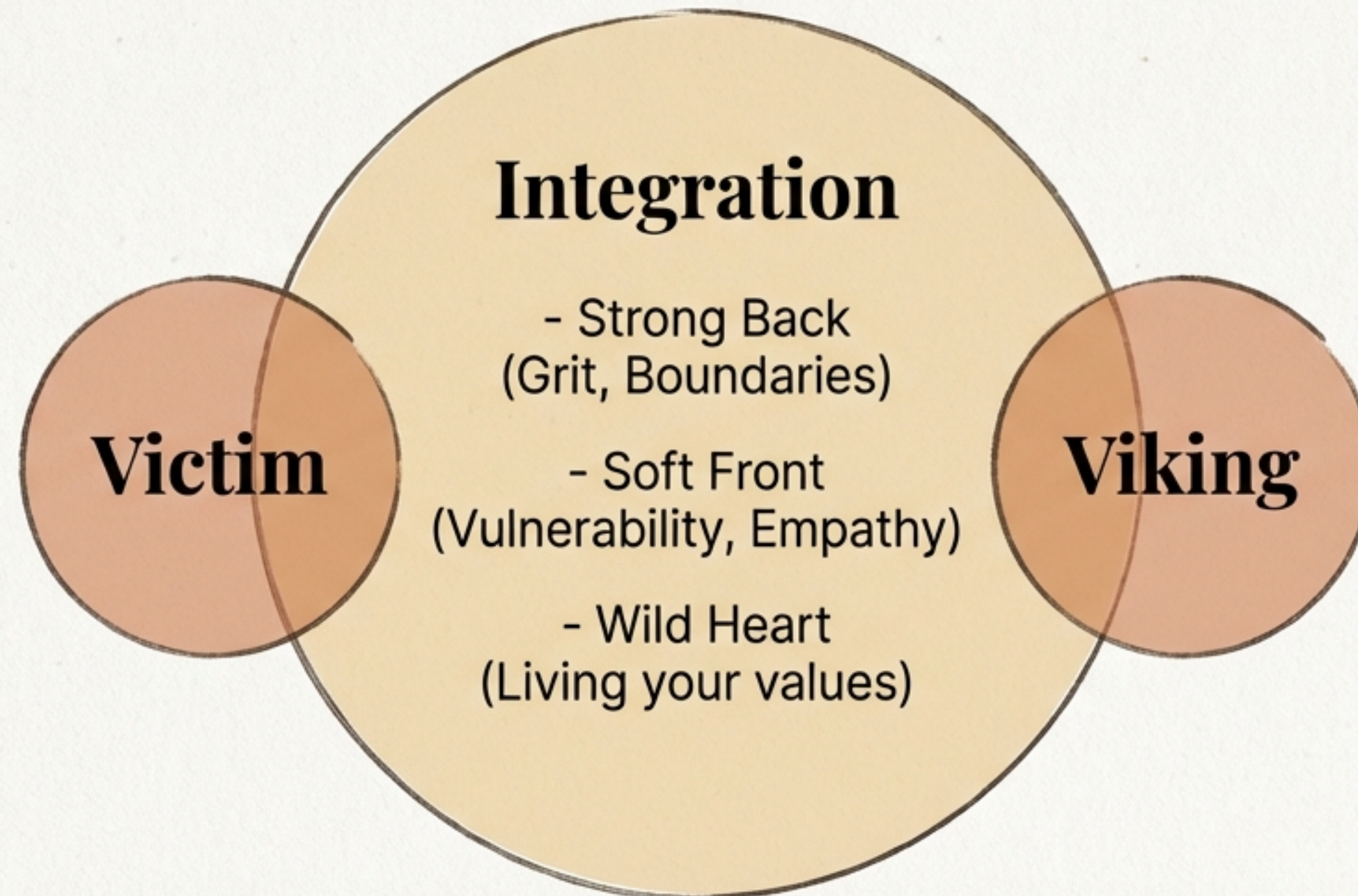


Gratitude

The Antidote: Gratitude.
People who can fully lean into delight practice thankfulness. Don't squander joy.

Armor Type 3: Victim or Viking

The Mindset: "Crush or be crushed." A worldview that sees only winners and losers. This binary ignores the capacity for integration.



Armor Type 4: Being a Knower

The Knower

- Needs to be right.
- Values being the "smartest in the room."
- Stifles innovation.

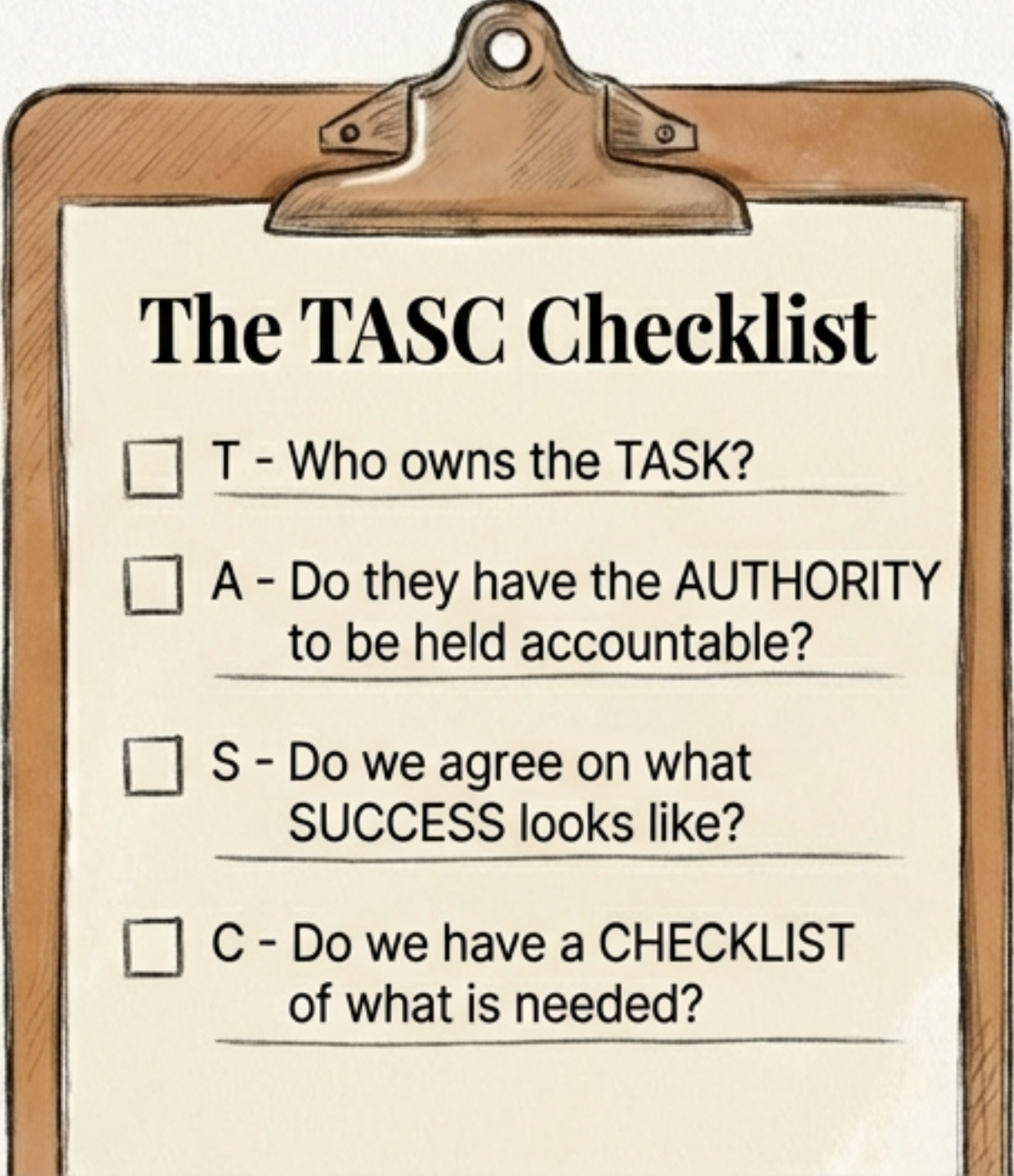
The Learner (Antidote)

- Replace "being right" with "getting it right."
- Values curiosity.
- Says "I don't know" with confidence.

Armor Type 5: Hustling for Worth

Antidote: The TASC Checklist

Stop the hustle by ensuring clarity before action.



The TASC Checklist

- ☐ T - Who owns the TASK?

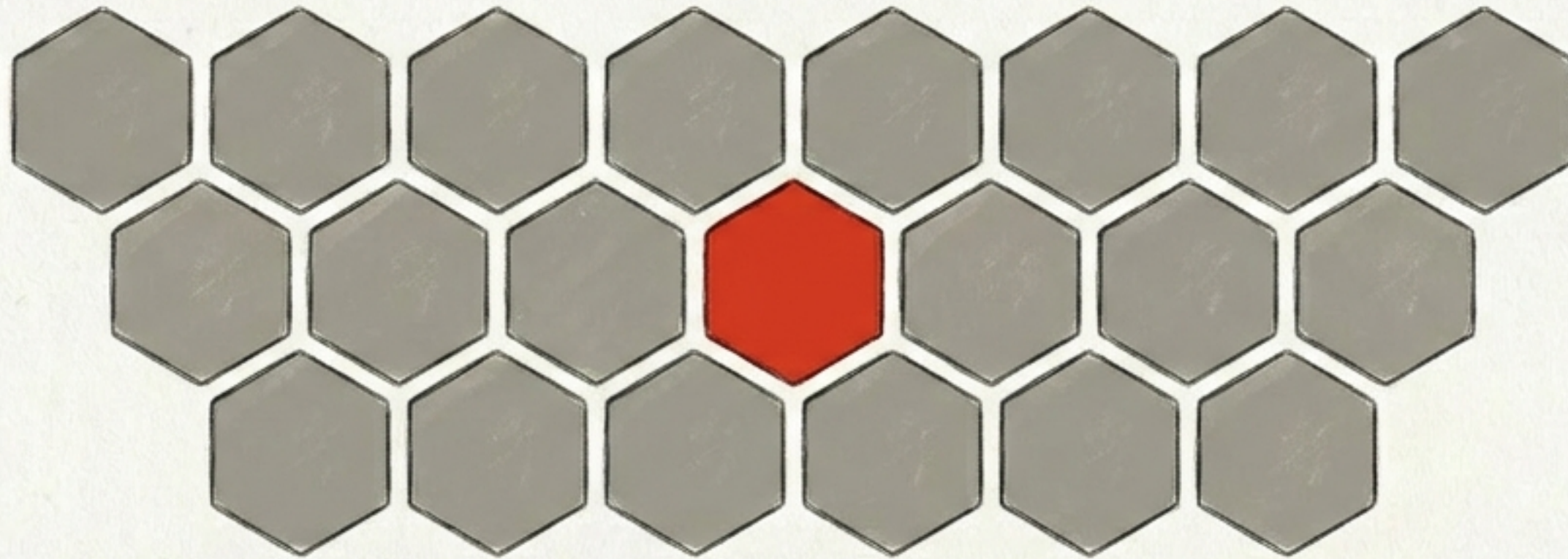
- ☐ A - Do they have the AUTHORITY
to be held accountable?

- ☐ S - Do we agree on what
SUCCESS looks like?

- ☐ C - Do we have a CHECKLIST
of what is needed?

Armor Type 6: Fitting In

Fitting in is changing who you are to be accepted.
True belonging requires you to be who you are.



Leadership Shift: Stop rewarding “fitting in” and echo chambers. Start rewarding those who ask questions and challenge the consensus.

The Action Plan

Three pivots to make this week:

1. Develop Others.

(Shift from hoarding power to empowering others—"Power with," not "Power over"). (Inter)

2. Encourage Strategic Thinking.

(Move from "doing it all yourself" to teaching the WHY and the HOW). (Inter)

3. Teach Your People.

(Stop fixing. Start coaching). (Inter)

Final Thought

